

How We Have a Cum-Worthy September

Joe + Ryan's September roadmap

SEPTEMBER 7–30, 2026 · REVISED FROM OUR WORKING SESSION

September exit conditions

Three objectives, supported by Joe + Ryan’s shared execution.

01 / Astir 001	The first event is locked internally: a confirmed date, venue, required people, equipment, logistics and a promotion plan with enough lead time.
02 / 30 friends	Thirty friends have the beta and can open it. The rebrand and a clear event experience meet the agreed release conditions.
03 / Brand	Our social presence and website are live. A shared system keeps publishing content, the first newsletter is ready, and the mailing list works.
Execution / Joe + Ryan	We own the app, event and brand work. Shared tools, clear responsibilities and a repeatable process support all three objectives.

September closes with evidence for each outcome. The event date can fall in October.

The order that makes this possible

Early work removes the dependencies that would otherwise consume the month.

First / Organize	Joe + Ryan agree capacity and split ownership. Pool brand assets, configure shared tools and start the workspaces.
Then / Establish	Start publishing in Week 1. Build the website and mailing list while researching event feasibility and writing the app’s event spec.
Next / Commit	Choose an event after checking its constraints. Build and test the app experience, gather early feedback, and expand toward 30 friends.
Finally / Close	Secure event commitments, resolve release blockers, and prove the publishing process works repeatedly with multiple contributors.

Proposed dates depend on the Sep 11 scope review. Preserve promotion lead time when choosing the event date.

The three objectives

01 / Astir 001 locked internally

We know exactly what will happen, who will make it happen and when.

Event discovery	Hold an event-planning session. Map the work, outside dependencies, costs and likely lead times before promising a date.
Concept choice	Develop the top two or three concepts. Compare audience, format, cost and complexity. Select a primary concept and a viable backup.
Date + commitments	Confirm venue access, required labor or vendors, equipment and logistics for one date. Record each commitment and unresolved condition.
Promotion plan	Prepare the story, assets, channels, registration route and release calendar. Agree both brand-establishment time and event-promotion time.
App relationship	Define how 001 appears in the app and where registration happens. Resolve that dependency jointly with Objective 02.

EXIT: an approved event brief and commitment record. Public promotion begins when the team agrees the event is ready.

The shared event workspace

One event record, visible and editable by everyone doing the work.

Brief + boundaries	Audience, experience, date options, geography, capacity, budget limit and what makes an opportunity worth pursuing.
Work breakdown	Venue, labor/vendors, equipment, logistics, promotion, registration and app integration. Each component has one accountable owner.
Current state	Track not started, contacting, awaiting reply, held, confirmed or blocked. Keep tentative holds distinct from confirmed bookings.
Action + evidence	Each item includes contact, quote or terms, due date, next action, dependency and a link to the commitment or decision.
Founder authority	Joe + Ryan split components and agree outreach criteria. Name the outreach owner and which commitments need a joint decision.

EXIT: every required component has an owner and a status. Any remaining blocker is visible before the date is called locked.

02 / The 30-friends beta

The gate measures people with access to a usable app. Feedback guides the next release.

Baseline + rebrand	Review search together against agreed tasks. Finish the rebrand and verify the baseline flows. The latest search changes still need acceptance.
Event experience	Deliver a clear event hub/tab and a coherent home for 001. Define the smallest version that protects the first impression.
Release conditions	Triage existing issues this week, define P0/P1 severity and fix release blockers. Check map performance on the candidate build.
Friends + feedback	Prepare a named roster and invite route. Collect the 30-question survey after use, hold follow-up meetings, and turn findings into prioritized fixes.
Gate measurement	Count distinct friends who receive the beta and successfully open it. Track feedback and use separately. Confirm the exact gate in Week 1.

EXIT: 30 verified friends with working access, a release that passes the agreed checklist, and a running survey, meeting and feedback process.

The full development scope

Objective 02 includes new work, release quality and changes learned from users.

Search acceptance	Joe + Ryan try the latest search together. Agree representative tasks, record gaps and distinguish acceptable beta quality from later improvements.
P0/P1 triage	Review existing bugs this week. Proposed P0: a critical flow is unusable or data is at risk. P1: a core task fails with no reasonable workaround.
Map performance	Verify the recent performance work on target devices and representative maps. Record slowdowns and regressions against agreed acceptance criteria.
Events + opt-in	Build the approved event experience and newsletter signup integration. Carry the app rebrand and any remaining baseline gaps in the same estimate.
Feedback fixes	Reserve recurring development blocks for survey and interview findings. Implement the highest-impact changes and retest them with users.

RELEASE GATE: accepted search and map behavior, agreed event scope, no open P0/P1 release blockers and tested feedback fixes.

Survey + follow-up meetings

Objective 02 includes a repeatable way to learn from the people using the app.

Before rollout	Pilot the 30-question Google Form with two testers. Name the collection owner, link the response sheet and check the time to complete.
After use	Send after a meaningful session or failed first attempt, ideally within 24–48 hours. Send one reminder after three days if needed.
Follow-up meetings	Offer a 20-minute conversation to willing respondents. Proposal: 8–10 meetings across the cohort, including blocked and successful users.
From answer to fix	Review responses daily. Record the task, expected result, actual result and impact. Turn actionable findings into owned issues.
Close the loop	Review themes weekly, verify fixes with testers and record retest outcomes. Track survey and meeting status separately from the 30-friends gate.

EXIT: a working form, response tracker, completed user conversations and a prioritized backlog with evidence.

The event feature needs a crisp spec

Joe + Ryan settle the product relationship before committing to a build date.

Experience	Define how someone discovers 001, understands it, opens details and registers. Specify upcoming, unavailable and empty states.
Model + navigation	Define event versus place, the relationship to the map, and where the event hub lives. Record any new data model or migration work.
Scope decision	Compare a minimal event hub with fuller integration. A place-profile shortcut or external form remains an option to evaluate.
Acceptance + tests	Test navigation, event details, registration handoff, map/place relationships and failure states. Include regression coverage for the existing app.
Release review	Run a joint walkthrough and user feedback session. Record pass/fail against the spec before increasing the friend cohort.

PROPOSED DEFAULT: include an event hub in the 30-friends release. Change that condition only through an explicit product decision.

03 / Brand presence + a publishing system

An established public presence and a process that keeps producing.

Identity + accounts	Align the app icon, social avatars, bios and voice with the rebrand. Set up Instagram and TikTok access and profile destinations.
Website	Launch the redesigned domain with a clear brand story and mailing-list signup. Add public event information once it is ready.
Mailing list	Connect website and app signup to the list. Build optional account-creation opt-in in REC-449 and test the subscriber flow.
Newsletter	Create the first complete issue, reusable format and editorial plan. Test delivery internally. Choose a public send date separately.
Publishing system	Create shared asset intake, ideas, drafts, review and scheduling. Multiple contributors can move work forward with clear ownership.

EXIT: live profiles and site, a working list, published content, a complete first newsletter and a repeatable editorial process.

App signup + the mailing list

A shared development dependency for Objective 02 and Objective 03.

Signup choice	An optional, unchecked newsletter checkbox appears during account creation. People can continue without subscribing.
Data + delivery	Save the user’s choice and sync explicit opt-ins to the mailing list. Test opt-in, opt-out, retries and failure handling.
One audience	Website signup and app signup feed the same agreed audience model. Existing unsubscribe choices remain respected.
Newsletter milestone	Create the complete first newsletter and test delivery internally. Public launch timing remains a separate editorial decision.

TRACKED IN LINEAR: [REC-449 / Optional newsletter opt-in during account creation](#)

The content workflow

Joe + Ryan run this cadence. Post counts below are cumulative.

Shared inputs	Pool existing photos, footage, references and ideas. Give contributors brand guidance and reusable templates from the start.
Editorial session	Joe + Ryan agree the workflow, topics, quality bar and review turnaround. One founder owns each post and the other reviews it.
One shared queue	Each item records the idea, assets, creator, reviewer, channel, publish date and status. Save the live link after publication.
Scheduler	Choose and configure an existing scheduler unless a specific unmet need justifies building one. Verify account access and a scheduled test post.
September proposal	Publish 15 original pieces: one each weekday from Sep 10–30. Create newsletter #1 by Sep 18, then review and rehearse delivery by Sep 25. Cross-posts do not add to the 15.

EXIT: Joe + Ryan repeat the workflow and queue the next week. Confirm cadence on Sep 9 and check the workload on Sep 11.

Founder setup + ownership

Joe + Ryan cover the plan. Shared setup supports Objectives 1, 2 and 3.

Ownership split	Name the app lead and the event + brand lead. Agree capacity, decision rights and a reviewer for each deliverable.
Access	Confirm both founders can use the repo, shared boards, brand assets, social accounts and publishing tools.
Tools + workflow	Use the Sep 9 editorial session to choose the scheduler, organize assets and agree a simple draft, review and publish process.
Content ownership	The event + brand lead batches content and owns the queue. The app lead reviews at agreed times. Complete the first cycle by Sep 11.
Event ownership	The event + brand lead owns outreach and commitments. The app lead owns event integration. Both founders approve scope and spending.

EXIT: by Sep 11, both founders have access, named work and one completed content cycle. Count no additional contributor capacity.

The month

Four weekly gates

Proposed workback. The Sep 11 review sets a realistic development forecast.

Objective	Sep 7–13 Set up + start	Sep 14–20 Build + validate	Sep 21–27 Commit + expand	Sep 28–30 Close + continue
1 / 001	Research planning. Compare 2–3 concepts. Start outreach.	Select concept. Check date, venue, people and equipment.	Secure commitments and complete promotion plan.	Verify the internal lock and announce only when ready.
2 / App + friends	Triage P0/P1s. Accept search. Check map performance. Spec events and opt-in. Pilot survey.	Build events and opt-in, fix blockers, collect first surveys and book follow- ups.	Develop feedback fixes, test the release and expand toward 30 when ready.	Verify 30 working installs and close critical gaps.
3 / Brand	Profiles, site and list. Start the queue. 2 posts proposed	Repeat production. Create newsletter #1. 7 posts cumulative	Keep publishing. Review newsletter and test delivery. 12 posts cumulative	Finish September and queue October. 15 posts cumulative
Founder execution	Split ownership. Set up shared tools and complete the first content cycle by Sep 11.	App lead builds. Event + brand lead handles outreach, content and newsletter production.	Keep founder production running. Review capacity alongside app feedback and event commitments.	Close owned gaps and queue October. No additional contributor assumed.

Sep 7–13 / Set up + start

A = first focus block. B = second focus block. Weekend work is optional buffer.

1 = Astir 001 / 2 = App + friends / 3 = Brand / A and B = work sessions

MON Sep 7	TUE Sep 8	WED Sep 9	THU Sep 10	FRI Sep 11	SAT Sep 12	SUN Sep 13
A / Working session Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 Settle the three objectives and record open decisions. B / Plan Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 Prepare the first joint sessions and the shared work list. OUTPUT Three objectives captured.	A / Ownership Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 Joe + Ryan split roles and capacity. Set up shared boards and assets. B / Foundations Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 App lead triages bugs. Event + brand lead maps planning and the content workflow. OUTPUT Owners + shared boards.	A / Product spec Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 Joint search acceptance. App lead defines event scope and newsletter opt-in. B / Editorial Objective 3 Joe + Ryan set the workflow. Choose scheduler and first pieces. OUTPUT Spec draft + content queue.	A / Event options Objectives 1 + 2 Event lead checks 2–3 concepts. App lead fixes triaged blockers. B / Brand build Objective 3 Event + brand lead finishes site/list setup and the first content cycle. Publish piece 1. OUTPUT Shortlist + first live post.	A / Scope gate Objective 2 Review P0/P1s, search, map performance and scope. Pilot survey. Forecast release. B / Brand launch Objective 3 Test site/list. Check founder workload. Publish piece 2. OUTPUT Forecast + live brand links.	Optional buffer Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 Use only for slipped setup work or creative asset gathering. OUTPUT No required milestone.	Optional reset Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 Review replies and prepare Monday’s work if useful. OUTPUT Next week ready.

Sep 14–20 / Build + validate

Joe + Ryan split app work and event + brand work. No third contributor is assumed.

1 = Astir 001 / 2 = App + friends / 3 = Brand / A and B = work sessions

MON Sep 14	TUE Sep 15	WED Sep 16	THU Sep 17	FRI Sep 18	SAT Sep 19	SUN Sep 20
A / Build Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 App: events, opt-in and P0/P1 fixes. Event lead resolves shortlist gaps. B / Editorial Objective 3 Batch the week’s assets and copy. Publish piece 3.	A / Event choice Objective 1 Choose concept and backup from feasibility evidence. B / Production Objectives 2 + 3 App lead continues build and fixes. Event + brand lead publishes piece 4.	A / App review Objectives 1 + 2 Walk the event flow, search and map. Review P0/P1 fixes against acceptance. B / Commitments Objectives 1 + 3 Confirm labor and equipment needs. Publish piece 5.	A / Testing Objectives 2 + 3 Test app, performance and opt-in. Prepare surveys and meeting slots. B / Newsletter Objective 3 Complete issue 1 and test delivery internally. Publish piece 6.	A / Release gate Objective 2 Review quality. Invite first friends if ready, then survey after meaningful use. B / Weekly proof Objectives 1 + 3 First newsletter ready. Publish piece 7. Review event commitments.	Optional buffer Objectives 1 + 2 Handle replies or release support if needed.	Optional reset Objective 3 Check the coming week’s queue and availability.
OUTPUT Build slice + weekly queue.	OUTPUT Concept + date candidates.	OUTPUT Issue list + event gaps.	OUTPUT Test results + email ready.	OUTPUT Go/no-go + seven posts.	OUTPUT No required milestone.	OUTPUT No required milestone.

Sep 21–27 / Commit + expand

Expansion follows release readiness. Event promotion follows the agreed launch conditions.

1 = Astir 001 / 2 = App + friends / 3 = Brand / A and B = work sessions

MON Sep 21	TUE Sep 22	WED Sep 23	THU Sep 24	FRI Sep 25	SAT Sep 26	SUN Sep 27
A / Feedback Objective 2 Review surveys and meet users. Build the highest-impact feedback fixes. B / Commitments Objectives 1 + 3 Close date and venue dependencies. Publish piece 8.	A / Event lock Objective 1 Confirm required people, equipment and logistics for the date. B / Publishing Objectives 2 + 3 Publish piece 9. Hold user meetings and turn evidence into app issues.	A / Promotion Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 Review event assets, signup route and lead-time calendar. B / App check Objectives 2 + 3 Retest feedback fixes and map performance. Review opt-in. Publish piece 10.	A / Gap close Objectives 1 + 2 Build remaining P0/P1 and feedback fixes. Event lead closes commitments. B / Newsletter Objective 3 Revise issue 1 from review. Prepare next content queue. Publish piece 11.	A / Weekly gate Objectives 1 + 2 Review internal event lock and progress toward 30 friends. B / Brand proof Objectives 2 + 3 Newsletter rehearsal complete. Publish piece 12. Review feedback themes.	Optional buffer Objectives 1 + 2 Handle time-sensitive replies or beta support.	Optional reset Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 Prepare the final three-day gap list.
OUTPUT Friend roster + venue state.	OUTPUT Commitment evidence.	OUTPUT Promotion plan + feedback.	OUTPUT Named gap list.	OUTPUT Lock status + twelve posts.	OUTPUT No required milestone.	OUTPUT Owners for remaining gaps.

Sep 28–30 / Close September

Finish the agreed outcomes and leave October ready to run.

1 = Astir 001 / 2 = App + friends / 3 = Brand / A and B = work sessions

MON / SEP 28	TUE / SEP 29	WED / SEP 30
A / Event + app gaps Objectives 1 + 2 Close outstanding event commitments. Verify beta access person by person and resolve critical issues. B / Content Objective 3 Event + brand lead publishes piece 13 and prepares October assets. Output Final gap list with accountable owners.	A / Full walkthrough Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 Review event readiness, the friend roster and the website-to-mailing-list journey. B / October queue Objective 3 Publish piece 14. Schedule next week and finalize the newsletter package. Output Proof links and a continuing publishing calendar.	A / Exit review Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 Check the three objectives and founder handoff. Record shipped work, remaining gaps and needed decisions. B / Next month Objectives 1 + 2 + 3 Publish piece 15. Agree event announcement timing and the next app priorities. Output September results and October owners.

How we run the work

Focus blocks + accountable owners

Joe + Ryan provide all planned capacity. Assign the two founder roles on Sep 8.

Founder capacity	Proposal: ten two-hour blocks per founder each week. Joint sessions count against both people’s capacity.
Parallel work	The app lead covers development and feedback fixes. The event + brand lead owns event planning, the site and content production.
Brand capacity	The event + brand lead budgets three blocks for brand, four for events, two for joint work and one buffer. Batch simple posts and use the scheduler.
Protected capacity	App lead: protect two feedback-fix blocks and one buffer. The other seven include joint reviews. Count site and list engineering here too.
Friday review	Open the work itself: build, event commitments, published links and subscriber flow. Reassign or reschedule any work without a credible path.

Day blocks are proposed focus windows, not calendar bookings. Print the daily sheet before work. Joint decisions need both founders; execution needs one owner.

Decisions that control the schedule

Resolve these early enough to change the plan while time remains.

Sep 8 / Ownership	Name the app lead and event + brand lead. Confirm both founders’ availability, access and authority for event commitments.
Sep 9 / Brand cadence	Confirm channels, post frequency, newsletter format and the shared workflow. The 15-post plan is a starting proposal. Newsletter success means first issue created.
Sep 11 / App scope	Estimate app work alongside site/list build, content and event work. Keep feedback time free. Reduce complexity or revise dates if the two-person budget does not fit.
Before event lock	Confirm brand-establishment and promotion lead times. Move the event date if commitments or readiness cannot support them.
If capacity tightens	Reduce optional event scope and production complexity first. Protect P0/P1 and feedback time. If 15 posts still do not fit, agree a revised cadence explicitly.

A partial event page, tentative venue hold or unfinished feature stays visibly incomplete until its acceptance conditions pass.

The September 30 review

Three objectives and a founder handoff. The evidence makes the result clear.

001 locked	Open the event brief, confirmed date, venue and required commitments. Review the promotion calendar and app dependency.
30 friends	Reconcile 30 distinct friends with working beta access. Open the release checklist, survey responses, meeting notes and prioritized feedback backlog.
Brand running	Open the social profiles, website, signup flow, published posts, completed newsletter, internal delivery test and the next scheduled queue.
Founder handoff	Review Joe + Ryan’s completed work, shared access and October owners. Confirm the next queue fits the two-person capacity plan.

Success leaves us with a credible first event, a beta in friends’ hands, a functioning brand presence and a team ready to keep going.